Sanaul Haque

Mahfuza_Osmani_Sreshtha_Proposal

Assignment 201

Document Details

Submission ID
trn:oid:::3117:634946681

Submission Date
Oct 6, 2026, 7:08 PM GMT+6

Download Date
Oct 6, 2026, 7:10 PM GMT+6

File Name
Mahfuza_Osmani_Sreshtha_Proposal.pdf

File Size
379.9 KB

7 Pages

2,464 Words

15,032 Characters

11% Overall Similarity

The combined total of all matches, including overlapping sources, for each database.

Match Groups

11 Not Cited or Quoted 8%
Matches with neither in-text citation nor quotation marks

3 Missing Quotations 1%
Matches that are still very similar to source material

2 Missing Citation 2%
Matches that have quotation marks, but no in-text citation

0 Cited and Quoted 0%
Matches with in-text citation present, but no quotation marks

Top Sources

8% Internet sources
7% Publications
11% Submitted works (Student Papers)

Match Groups

- **11** Not Cited or Quoted 8%
  Matches with neither in-text citation nor quotation marks
- **3** Missing Quotations 1%
  Matches that are still very similar to source material
- **2** Missing Citation 2%
  Matches that have quotation marks, but no in-text citation
- **0** Cited and Quoted 0%
  Matches with in-text citation present, but no quotation marks

Top Sources

8% Internet sources
7% Publications
11% Submitted works (Student Papers)

Top Sources

The sources with the highest number of matches within the submission. Overlapping sources will not be displayed.

1	Internet	
www.ijfmr.com		2%
2	Student papers	
Leiden University on 2026-05-16		1%
3	Student papers	
Ahmedabad University on 2026-09-10		1%
4	Publication	
Sameen Nasar, Saifa Raz, Ateeb Ahmad Parray, Muhammad Riaz Hossain et al. "A...		1%
5	Student papers	
University of New South Wales on 2025-11-24		1%
6	Internet	
fm-cab.blogspot.com		1%
7	Student papers	
Canterbury Christ Church University on 2026-01-14		<1%
8	Student papers	
Navitas Professional Institute Pty Ltd on 2024-07-15		<1%
9	Student papers	
Southern Cross University on 2026-07-26		<1%
10	Student papers	
Erasmus University of Rotterdam on 2020-01-06		<1%

11 Publication

Faria Ahmed. "The Multiplicity of Institutions in Rohingya Refugee Camps and Its ... <1%

12 Publication

Nuruzzaman Khan, Md Badsha Alam, Md Shohel Rana, Karen Block. "Unmet need ... <1%

13 Student papers

University of London External System on 2023-07-26 <1%

14 Student papers

University of New South Wales on 2026-10-02 <1%

15 Student papers

Virginia Community College System on 2021-07-10 <1%

IARCO RESEARCH PROPOSAL 2026

Full Legal Name: Mahfuza Osmani Sreshtha

Institution: University of Dhaka

Category: Senior

Grade: 1st Year, B.Ed.

Country: Bangladesh

Major (Senior): Bachelor of Education (Hons.), Institute of Education and Research (IER)

Submission Date: September 11, 2026

Registered Email Address: sreosmani5@gmail.com

Research Title: The Displacement Squeeze: Assessing the Erosion of Host-Community Education in Cox's Bazar Amid the Rohingya Refugee Crisis: A Mixed-Methods Difference-in-Differences and Case Study Approach

8

The Displacement Squeeze: Assessing the Erosion of Host-Community Education in Cox's Bazar Amid the Rohingya Refugee Crisis: A Mixed-Methods Difference-in-Differences and Case Study Approach

Introduction

Worldwide displacement numbers have escalated to record levels, converting ongoing refugee situations into an entrenched structural problem for developing countries that serve as hosts. Important terminology such as "protracted displacement," "host-community vulnerability," and "educational equity" have been identified as key frameworks to explain how rapid demographic changes disrupt public services in the region. Well before the events of 2017, Cox's Bazar was identified as being the least educated district in all of Bangladesh, suffering from the worst student performance and school completion rates in the nation [4].

This vulnerability was exacerbated by August 2017, when targeted persecution in Myanmar led to over 742,000 refugees coming into the country, mostly settling in Ukhiya and Teknaf and raising the number of displaced people to one million [1]. To meet the needs of this tremendous humanitarian operation, there has been great stress on the local infrastructure and public services, with almost 300,000 Bangladeshi nationals in Ukhiya and Teknaf classified as vulnerable and in need of assistance along with refugees [6, 7].

It is essential to understand this particular strain because the socio-economic sustainability of southeastern Bangladesh requires resilient institutions. Failure to curb the resource conflict may lead to an uneducated generation among host-community youth as well as displaced children.

Whereas humanitarian coverage of the situation rightly covers educational obstacles faced by the Rohingya youth such as restrictions to a Myanmar-centric curriculum, closure of community-driven learning centers, and exclusion from tertiary education [3, 5], there is little coverage of the secondary stress on public institutions, including schools that serve as the backbone of education for local Bengali kids [2]. To close the knowledge gap, the objective of this research is to examine the extent of erosion in the educational system of the host community and understand the structure of the strain on the system. This research addresses the primary research question outlined below.

Research Questions and Objectives

Primary research question: To what extent and how have the educational outcomes of host community children in the upazilas of Ukhiya and Teknaf been affected by the Rohingya humanitarian response after 2017?

- **RQ1:** What changes have occurred in enrollment, retention, and pupil-teacher ratio at host-community schools after 2017 in relation to pre-crisis levels and non-affected upazilas?
- **RQ2:** In what ways are these educational changes among the host community caused by factors like teacher recruitment for humanitarian work, land conversion for schools, and classroom overcrowding in host-community schools?

- **RQ3:** What is the relative importance and experience of these institutional pressures for local teachers, parents, and education administrators at their schools?
- **RQ4:** Where do the host-community educational pressures intersect with or diverge from policy structures related to Rohingya refugee education?

The objectives of this research are:

- **RO1:** To measure changes in host-community enrollment, retention, and pupil-teacher ratio using Difference-in-Differences modeling for the 2014-2025 panel data.
- **RO2:** To assess the effect of teacher attrition, land diversion, and classroom overcrowding using comparative school audits of target and control upazilas.
- **RO3:** To explore how host-community teachers, administrators, and parents perceive and rank these resource challenges using Key Informant Interviews.
- **RO4:** To construct policy compatibility and contradictions within a mechanism map between national host-community education policies and the refugee education policy framework.

Literature Review

The scale of the crisis is unambiguous: almost one million Rohingya refugees live in Cox's Bazar following the violence targeting the population in August 2017 [1], and the 2025–2026 Joint Response Plan sees 1.48 million individuals- Rohingya refugees and their hosts- in need of help [7], officially equating the two groups as bearing one humanitarian burden.

The literature on the topic can be divided into two relatively independent streams. The first approach provides evidence of obstacles that the refugee children face: a curriculum focused on repatriation rather than integration, closure of thirty community and home-based learning centers from 2021 to 2022, and lack of educational opportunities for the Rohingya youth [3], [5]. The second approach, albeit much narrower, focuses on the problems of the host community itself. This is where the contextual gap in the literature exists, rather than in the number of studies dedicated to the refugee population.

What the second, more slender corpus can tell us, however, is that the erosion is serious. Cox's Bazar was going into the situation at a serious disadvantage, as it was among the areas with the highest dropout rates and lowest achievement levels of Bangladesh even prior to 2017 [4], so the refugee crisis did not put a system under stress but rather emphasized an existing problem. The survey-based studies point to tangible mechanisms behind this: loss of agricultural land, social cohesion erosion, and infrastructure stress, all leading to households' reduced ability to enroll their children [6]; in addition to that, there is also an increasing migration of local teachers and senior students from schools into NGOs due to better pay [6], especially exacerbated by the COVID-19 situation.

Studies based on fieldwork reveal that community-based approaches are essential for capturing the true nature of life of displaced communities, not top-down data collection efforts [3]. This study is following it directly. In combination, these references clearly indicate that three things are not in question: (1) The magnitude of the displacement is large and geographically concentrated in Cox's Bazar; (2) Host-community schools were already weak before 2017, and have faced continuing pressure since then; and (3) The barriers faced by camp learners have been well established. The cases of Dadaab, Kenya [1], and Ugandan districts that have hosted

refugees [2] clearly show a common pattern whereby the local schools cope with the refugee impact through class overcrowding, shortage of teachers, and unfulfilled enrollments despite having refugee camps with schools. This study aims to determine if the same is true for the less understood case of Cox's Bazar. The distinction between the two perspectives is that of the focus of the experiences involved; however, there is currently no literature that documents the eroding state of the host-community schooling system, links it mechanically to the pressures of the humanitarian response, and centers the views of the local teachers and school administrators, rather than merely the aggregate numbers. This is the void that this research attempts to fill and this is an important point since policies geared towards solving the problems of refugees alone may miss the fact that it is the weakening of the host community that makes the humanitarian effort unsustainable. The contribution of the study to knowledge can be summed up in the Mechanism Map, which was developed for the first time ever by juxtaposing the pressures from the host-community institutions against the national and refugees' education policies text.

For this reason, this study utilizes a mixed-methods design, which combines a quantitative analysis of panel data with qualitative key informant interviews.

Proposed Methodology

1. Research Philosophy

The rationale behind using a pragmatist approach for this study is that the research question requires not only objectivity but also subjectivity: The former explains how change happens on a macro level in terms of enrollment and PTR while the latter explains how change happens to teachers and principals at an individual level through displacement pressure."

2. Research Methods

The application of a mixed-methods research approach will be conducted to design the following four steps: (1) secondary data analysis and trend modeling, (2) KIIs, (3) comparative case studies of schools, and (4) document analysis and triangulation. The choice of this methodology is justified by the ability of this approach to differentiate between displacement-specific changes and general national effects (post COVID-19 economic pressure, inflation in the whole country).

3. Sample

11

Quantitative: All primary and secondary schools in the Ukhiya and Teknaf upazilas (Cox's Bazar) compared to control upazilas not affected by the problem in the same district.

KIIs: 20-25 interviews via purposive sampling of 4 stakeholder groups: Headteachers/Assistant teachers (n=10); Upazila Education Officers/Assistant UEOs (n=4); EiE program officers from local/international NGOs (n=6); and SMC/Parent Group members (n=4).

Case studies: 6 government schools, 4 within 5km of camp boundaries (Ukhiya/Teknaf), 2 controls beyond 25km (Ramu); matched on pre-2017 enrollment, upazila poverty rate, and school type

4. Data Types

Both quantitative (enrollment, retention/dropout, pupil-teacher ratio) and qualitative (interview transcripts, audit checklist, policy documents) data will be gathered, in line with the study's twofold objective of assessing the scale and understanding the mechanism behind it.

5. Data Collection Methods

Secondary data: BANBEIS annual reports (2014 to 2025) complemented with JRP and ESCG humanitarian data trackers, compared to pre-crisis baselines (2014 to 2016), national district averages, and control upazila data.

KIIs: Semi-structured interviews rating three major pressures, recruitment of teachers for

humanitarian work, encroachment on facilities and lands, and overcrowding of classes with displaced host community members.
Case studies: Measures functional student/teacher ratio, facility condition, land use within the compound, and teacher presence-on-duty versus payroll.
Document analysis: Codes policy directives (e.g., Myanmar Curriculum Pilot guidance, community-led school policies) against host-community development plans.

6. Analysis Methods

The quantitative trends are calculated using difference-in-differences, where the control upazilas are matched based on same policy environment in the districts, lack of presence of camps, and similar pre-2017 enrollment rates and poverty levels, along with 2014-2016 BANBEIS data that shows similar trends. The qualitative interviews and audit data are thematically analyzed. The three datasets are triangulated into a **"Mechanism Map"** by comparing RQ2/RQ3 pressures (teacher migration, land use, overcrowding) with education policies nationally and for refugees.

Implementation Timeline, Resource Allocation, & Risk Mitigation

Duration	Key Operational Activities	Required Resources and Estimated Budget
Phase 1: **Preparation and Ethics (Months 1–3)**	Secure IRB & local permits (DC, DEO, UEOs); aggregate BANBEIS, JRP & ESCG datasets	Official permit processing & administrative fees: **BDT 15,000** (~$125)
Phase 2: **Modeling (Months 4–5)**	Clean panel data; run baseline DiD models (Stata/R); pilot KII & audit tools	Licenses, validation & piloting: **BDT 10,000** (~$85)
Phase 3: **Field Work (Months 6–7)**	6-week Cox's Bazar deployment: 20–25 KIIs + 6 school audits	Local transport & 1 Chittagonian-fluent field assistant: **BDT 240,000** (~$2,000)
Phase 4**: Synthesis (Months 8–12)**	Transcribe interviews; NVivo thematic coding; triangulate policy documents; write manuscript	Data transcription checks & document acquisition: **BDT 15,000** (~$125)
Total Scope	Executable 12-month single-researcher project	**Grand Total: BDT 280,000** (~$2,335)

In order to maintain operational feasibility and to take into consideration any possible disruptions that may occur while conducting the research in Ukhiya and Teknaf, the following is a list of possible risks, levels of impact, and their mitigation measures:

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation Strategy
Data Collection Delays	High	Medium	Extended timeline buffer + direct liaison

			with local education offices
Field Access & Security Near Camps	High	Medium	Partner with local admins; secure district permits early; hire Chittagonian-fluent field assistant
Missing Panel Data (BANBEIS)	High	Medium	Address missing historical data via **multiple imputation (MICE).**
Self-Reporting Bias in KIIs	Medium	High	Cross-verify KII insights against Phase 3 audit scores

Limitations of Methods & Risk Reduction Strategy

1. **Missing Data from Secondary Data Sources:** The missing panel data in the BANBEIS will be addressed via multiple imputation by chained equations (MICE).
2. **Delay in Administrative Permits:** The risk of delay due to administrative clearance will be minimized through early application for permits in Phase 1.
3. **Self-Reporting:** The self-reported insights obtained through interviews will be cross-verified via independent Phase 3 audit scores.

If the six-week window compresses, surveys in top-priority upazilas are completed first; the field assistant owns logistics and data collection, and I own instrument design and analysis.

Ethics and Institutional Approvals

1. IRB approval is to be sought before fieldwork commences.
2. Permits will be sought from the DEO and the Upazila Education Offices for research purposes.
3. Participant teachers will provide informed consent. For confidentiality purposes, no identification information will be disclosed.

Expected Outcomes

1. Impact of Refugee Response on Host Community Schools Measured: Evidence of the refugee response's impact on host community enrollment, dropout rates, and class size in Ukhiya and Teknaf through analysis of pre/post-2017 trends compared to non-affected districts.
2. Understanding the Drivers Behind Institutional Pressure: An analysis of the main factors contributing to school pressures from the host community perspective, namely the teacher outflow problem, land/facilities utilization, and overcrowding**.**
3. Connecting Humanitarian Response to Host Community School Needs: A model for linking humanitarian assistance of the Rohingya children to the underlying needs of the host community schools, highlighting the double erosion issue at play during the crisis.
4. Actionable Recommendations Based on Data: Practical suggestions for donor agencies, MoPME, and other government departments: Joint training of teachers, improving facilities, and cooperative planning to the advantage of both parties.

References

[1] Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA), (n.d.), *"The Impact of Large-Scale Forced Displacement on Rohingya Refugees and Host Communities in Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh,"* [Online]. Available: https://poverty-action.org/impact-large-scale-forced-displacement-rohingya-refugees-and-host-communities-coxs-bazar-bangladesh [Accessed: Sep. 11, 2026].

[2] ACAPS, *"Bangladesh: Needs and priorities of Rohingya refugees and host communities in Cox's Bazar since 2017: What has changed?,"* ReliefWeb, Aug. 30, 2022. [Online]. Available: https://reliefweb.int/report/bangladesh/bangladesh-needs-and-priorities-rohingya-refugees-and-host-communities-coxs-bazar-2017-what-has-changed [Accessed: Sep. 11, 2026].

[3] M. A. Hoque, T. Ahmad, S. Manzur, and T. K. Prova, *"Community-Based Research in Fragile Contexts: Reflections From Rohingya Refugee Camps in Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh,"* Journal on Migration and Human Security, vol. 11, no. 1, 2023, doi: 10.1177/23315024231160153.

[4] Education Cannot Wait, (n.d.), *"Bangladesh,"* [Online]. Available: https://www.educationcannotwait.org/our-investments/where-we-work/bangladesh [Accessed: Sep. 11, 2026].

[5] Amnesty International, *"Bangladesh: Restore and strengthen capacity of community-led schools in Rohingya camps,"* Apr. 2022. [Online]. Available: https://www.amnesty.org/en/latest/news/2022/04/bangladesh-restore-and-strengthen-capacity-of-community-led-schools-in-rohingya-camps/ [Accessed: Sep. 11, 2026].

[6] B. Biswas, M. N. Ahsan, and B. Mallick, *"Analysis of residential satisfaction: An empirical evidence from neighbouring communities of Rohingya camps in Cox's Bazar, Bangladesh,"* PLoS ONE, vol. 16, no. 4, e0250838, Apr. 2021, doi: 10.1371/journal.pone.0250838.

[7] UNHCR and Inter Sector Coordination Group, *"2025–26 Joint Response Plan: Rohingya Humanitarian Crisis in Bangladesh,"* Mar. 2025. [Online]. Available: https://bangladesh.un.org/en/291459-2025-26-joint-response-plan-rohingya-humanitarian-crisis-bangladesh [Accessed: Sep. 11, 2026].